

Consider your decision to come to Notre Dame. Here is one way

things could have gone:

Would the fact that the brain event occurred 300ms before
the conscious awareness make your decision unfree?

The decision

You consciously thought about it for a long time. You weighed the pros (great academic reputation, football, wonderful philosophy professors) and the cons (weather, the university theology requirement). Finally, after months of stewing, you decided to come to Notre Dame.

That decision involved a brain event and a conscious awareness of the decision. The brain event (RP-onset) occurred about 300ms before the conscious awareness.



replies to
Libet

A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the Libet experiments" is written in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font, centered horizontally and vertically.

the Libet
experiments



is free will
an important
good?

things could have gone:



Consider your decision to name. Here is one way



Would the fact that the brain evolved 300ms before

are you conscious of making your decisions unfree?





Therapeutic
disinfection

weighed the pros (great academic reputation, football,

You consciously thought about it for a long time. You

That decision involved a race and a decision

the university technology requirement). Finally, after

months of stewing, you decided to Notre Dame.

occurred about 300ms before the decision was made.

awareness of the decision. The brain event (RP-onset)

wonderful philosophy professors) and the cons (whether,



replies to
Libet

will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free









